

## **Report: Insights on marketing strategies of a sector focused private equity investment firm**

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### **Abstract**

This report provides an in depth analysis of the traditional methods of relationship building and credibility building by enhancing long term relationships with investors and portfolio companies in the age of heavy and aggressive marketing strategies pushed by companies and organisations. I have obtained these insights by getting into touch with **Mr Sunil Thakur, Partner at Quadria Capital**. The findings tell us a lot about how investment firms can grow by focusing on one sector and doubling down on it.

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### **Introduction**

In the financial sector, at times the marketing strategies do not matter because it becomes irrelevant when it is not majorly a customer facing industry. A lot goes on in the background, it is not always about digital marketing, the principles of marketing, advertising, branding and is all about just deep expertise, sector knowledge, stronger relationships with long term clients and much more. Through a simple telephonic interview with **Mr Sunil Thakur, Partner at Quadria Capital**, I wish to bring all that I have learned on paper.

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## **Overview of Quadria Capital**

[Quadria Capital](#) is a Singapore based independent private equity firm founded in 2012 by Abrar Mir and Dr. Amit Varma, specializing in growth capital investments within the healthcare sector across South and Southeast Asia. Managing over US\$4.3 billion in assets, the firm focuses on healthcare delivery, life sciences, medical technology, and services, targeting mid sized, high growth companies. Its distinguished characteristic is that its partners and investment professionals combine medical, clinical and financial expertise to make it a specialized platform. The firm does not focus on early stage startups, its primary focus is mid market healthcare companies with revenues between INR 400 to 500 crores and INR 3000 to 4000 crores. These are profitable and cash generating businesses that require growth capital to expand globally. One fine example would be **AIG Hospitals, Hyderabad**.

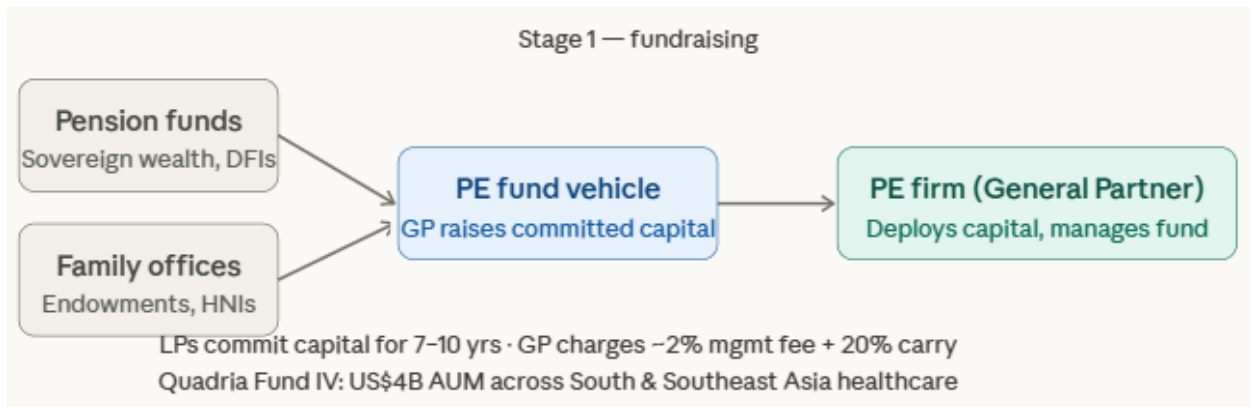
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**Objectives:**

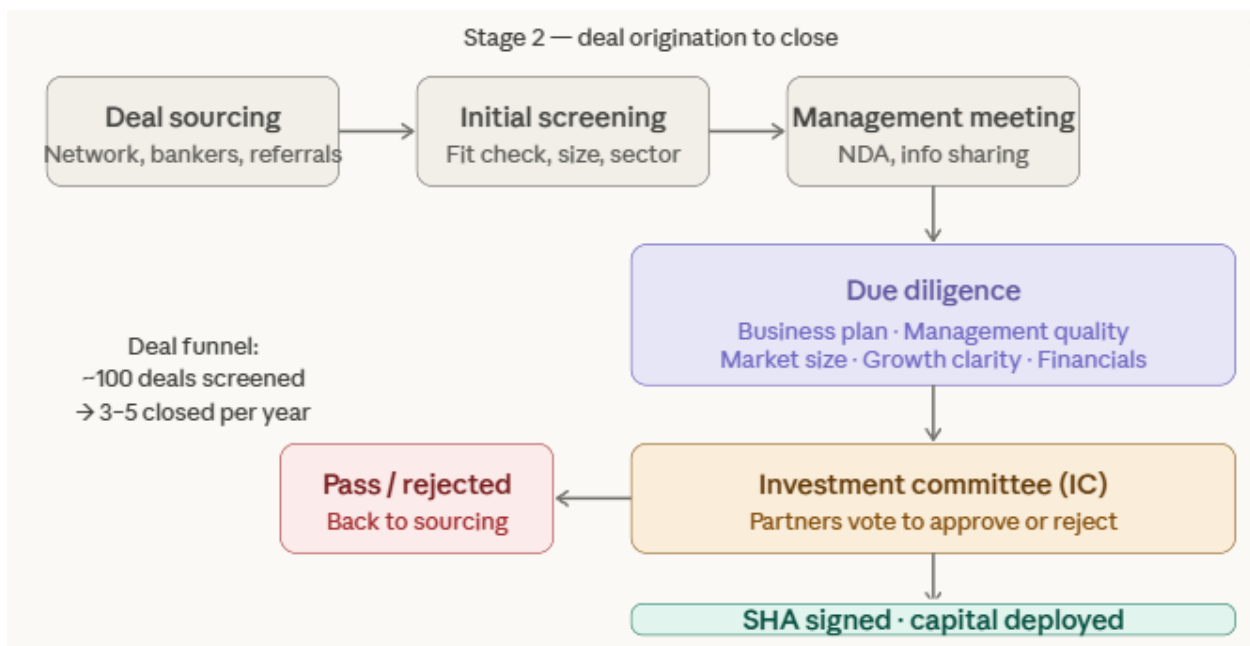
1. Understanding how an investment flows in private equity.
  2. How focusing on a single sector helps Quadria Capital stay on top of its game.
  3. How strong relationships and deep expertise on sector knowledge outshines aggressive marketing.
  4. Channels and mediums utilized to reach investors and portfolio companies.
  5. Post covid adaptation.
  6. Macroeconomic trends, demographics and regulations turning into challenges
  7. Evolution of healthcare investing evolved over past twenty years.
  8. How is a healthcare company valued?
  9. Major trends shaping the future of healthcare investment in Asia.
  10. Influence of AI in healthcare and investment decisions. Key Insights and learnings from the interview
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## 1. Investment at a Private Equity firm

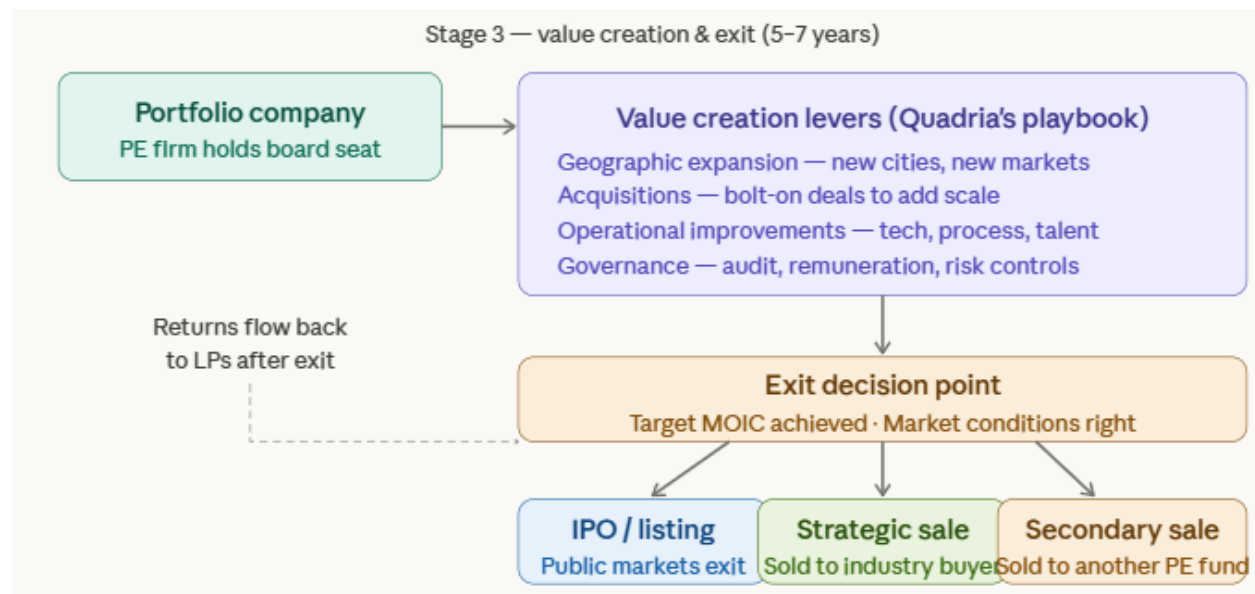
Stage 1. Fundraising: Before a PE firm can invest a single rupee, it needs to raise a fund from institutional investors called Limited Partners. This is itself a sales and marketing process.



Stage 2. Finding and closing a deal: Once the fund is raised, the GP deploys that capital into portfolio companies. This is the most labour intensive part, it involves sourcing, screening, deep due diligence, and negotiating legal terms. Mr Sunil described exactly this process in the interview.



Stage3. Value creation and exit: Closing the deal is only the midpoint. The real work and the real returns come from what happens over the next 5–7 years inside the portfolio company, followed by a carefully chosen exit route.



## 2. Marketing strategy analysis

### Understanding the context: Institutional vs retail financial marketing

Before understanding Quadria through the lens of a marketing framework it is important that we first understand what kind of financial services firm it is and who the actual customers are. Retail has mutual funds, insurance and personal loans, one example would be Vedant Asset, these firms target millions of individual consumers through mass media but on the contrary PE firms operate in an entirely B2B model. Quadria's clients are of two types, mainly:

- Limited partners (LPs): Institutional investors such as pension funds, sovereign wealth funds, family offices, endowments, and development finance institutions who commit capital to Quadria's funds
- Portfolio Companies: Mid-market healthcare businesses whose founders and promoters Quadria approaches for investment

### Understanding textbook knowledge in context to real life example: drawing parallels between 7Ps marketing framework and Quadria's functioning

| 7P Element | Meaning                  | Retail                                 | Institutional                                                                                   |
|------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Product    | Core offering            | Savings account, SIP, insurance policy | Healthcare growth equity fund; sector expertise; value-add advisory post-investment             |
| Price      | Cost to client           | Interest rates, fees, premiums         | Management fee (~2%) + carried interest (~20%); aligned with LP's long-term return expectations |
| Place      | Distribution channel     | Branches, apps, agents, online portals | Singapore HQ; New Delhi office; direct engagement across South & Southeast Asia                 |
| Promotion  | Communication & outreach | TV ads, digital campaigns, influencers | Industry conferences, healthcare forums, LP roadshows, referral                                 |

|                          |                           |                                           |                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                          |                           |                                           | networks; no social media advertising                                                 |
| <b>People</b>            | Frontline representatives | Relationship managers, financial advisors | Partners with clinical + M&A + operational backgrounds; this is the product itself    |
| <b>Process</b>           | Service delivery system   | Loan processing, KYC, claim settlement    | Deal sourcing → due diligence → IC approval → SHA negotiation → value creation → exit |
| <b>Physical Evidence</b> | Tangible proof of service | Bank statement, policy document           | Track record, AUM, portfolio exits, LP testimonials, case studies like AIG Hospitals  |

### **The B2B Marketing Model: Why no need of social media?**

One shocking revelation was when I pointed out Quadria Capital's missing social media presence, Mr Sunil explained that digital marketing was only relevant for only retail, not for any institutional setup and the firm's presence is generally at conferences, network events and industry forums and further adds that it is a reference driven market.

All of this gets validated as in institutional PE firms, reputation matters the most. It compounds much like capital itself. Limited Partners recommend it to peers and founders who had positive experiences introduce it to fellow promoters and that's how the deal flows.

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### **3. Sectoral focus: why sector is better than diversification?**

Quadria's exclusive focus on healthcare is far more than an investment thesis, it is a positioning strategy with powerful marketing that actually works where hundreds of private equity funds compete for deals and LP capital, a firm that has spent over a decade exclusively studying, investing in, and building healthcare businesses occupies a fundamentally different competitive position than a generalist fund that occasionally invests in healthcare.

It gives the firm 3 advantages:

- a. Credibility with founders and promoters
  - b. Proprietary deal flow and network effects
  - c. LP differentiation
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#### **4. Macro trends, challenges, plan of actions and future**

The interview highlighted several macroeconomic and structural forces that shape both the investment thesis and the communication of that thesis to investors:

- Rising incomes and ageing populations across Asia increase healthcare demand predictability
  - Technology & AI: AI driven diagnostics, clinical decision support, and digital health platforms are opening new sub sectors that Quadria actively monitors
  - Policy environment: Government initiatives around healthcare access, PMJAY, and medical device manufacturing incentives create regulatory tailwinds that are embedded in Quadria's investor pitch
  - Post COVID Resilience: Business continuity planning and management's ability to pivot are now explicit investment criteria, reflecting a shift in how resilience is marketed to risk-conscious LPs
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## **Personal Learnings and Key Takeaways**

This interaction with Mr. Sunil Thakur offered perspectives that go well beyond what a classroom or textbook can provide. Several insights stood out as particularly formative:

Marketing at the institutional level is relationship architecture, not communication. In retail financial services, marketing is about reach and persuasion. In private equity, it is about being present in the right rooms, at the right events, with the right reputation. The firm itself becomes the brand and that brand is built through performance, not promotion.

Sector specialisation is a moat, not a limitation. Quadria's exclusive focus on healthcare might appear to restrict opportunity. In practice, it amplifies every competitive advantage from deal origination to due diligence quality to LP trust. This reinforced for me that in complex, high-value markets, depth consistently outperforms breadth.

The 7Ps are universal, but their expression is context dependent. Walking through how each marketing element applies to a PE firm was an exercise in abstract thinking. It made me appreciate that the frameworks we learn are lenses, not prescriptions the analyst's job is to adapt them intelligently to the business context.

Career advice that resonated: Mr. Thakur advised students to 'build on your fundamentals in corporate finance and valuation study a lot about businesses beyond healthcare or private equity... and be good at storytelling and articulation.' This is a reminder that technical competence is necessary but not sufficient communication and commercial awareness are equally critical in finance.

## **Conclusion**

Quadria Capital is a unique case study for a course on marketing of financial services because it challenges students to look for marketing where it does borrow the methods such as advertising, branding, and promotion. The firm markets itself through specialisation, through process excellence, through the skills of its people, and through the returns it generates for investors and founders alike. In doing so, it offers a compelling argument that in the most sophisticated corners of financial services, the best marketing strategy is to simply be the best at what you do.